Guess the Story -- Practice sheet

Name: _____

Full question bank

1. Guess the title from this description: Greek hero noted for his great strength. Performed 12 labors during his years of servitude to Eurystheus, King of Tiryns. The 12 labors were: the Nemean Lion, the Lernean Hydra, the Cerynitian hind, the Erymanthian boar, Augeian stables, Stymphalian birds, Cretan bull, mares of Diomedes, Hippolyte's belt, cattle of Geryon, apples of the Hesperides, and Cerberus.

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2. Guess the title from this description: Son of Danae and Zeus. His grandfather, fearing that the hero would one day kill him, put the mother and son into a box and set it into the sea. Zeus saved them. When a grown man, he slew first the Medusa, with some help from Athena, and then the sea monster which threatened the life of Andromeda who had been chained to a rock as sacrifice.

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3. Guess the title from this description: the musician was the most famous musician of mythology. He went to the Underworld to lead back his wife his wife, who had died from a snake bite. the musician charmed the Gods by his music and was allowed to lead his wife out of the Underworld if he did not look back at her. He looked back and lost her.

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4. Guess the title from this description: Lovers whose parents opposed their marriage whose love led to their tragic deaths.

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5. Guess the title from this description: A Greek hero who slew the Minotaur (half-man and half-bull) with the aid of Ariadne, daughter of King Minos of Crete. She told him to use a ball of string to find his way out of the labyrinth after slaying the minotaur. He did. He then abandoned Ariadne and went back to his home Athens.

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6. Guess the title from this description: A beautiful young woman who would marry only the man who could beat her in a running race. Many suitors tried and lost their lives as a condition of the defeat. the young woman was finally defeated by Hippomenes when she paused to pick up the 3 golden apples he tossed as they ran. It was Venus who gave him the apples.

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7. Guess the title from this description: A great enchantress of mythology who was able to change men into wild beasts. She changed Odysseus's men into pigs when they visited her island Aeaea. Odysseus with the magic herb (moly) given to him by Hermes forced the enchantress to change the beasts into human form again.

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8. Guess the title from this description: The wife of Odysseus who waited faithfully for him while he was absent for 20 years. She spent her time weaving a cloth which was to be a shroud for her father-in-law Laertes. When she finished the cloth, she was supposed to choose one of her many suitors to marry. To postpone this, she unraveled by night what she had woven by day.

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9. Guess the title from this description: A beautiful queen of Thebes who boasted that she was superior to Leto, the mother of Artemis and Apollo. Apollo slew her 7 sons and Artemis her 7 daughters. Then the queen was turned to stone as she mourned the loss of her children.

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10. Guess the title from this description: the young man was a handsome and conceited young man. the nymph was a beautiful nymph who fell in love with him. He ignored her and fell in love with his own reflection in a pool of water. Then he fell in trying to embrace himself and died.

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11. Guess the title from this description: The king of the Phrygians who restored Silenus, the teacher of Dionysus, to Dionysus. Dionysus gave the king the choice of a gift. the king chose that all he touched would turn to gold. When the king asked for release from this unwise choice, he was told to bathe in the river Pactolus. When he did, the power left him and passed into the river, and the sand of the river became golden.

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12. Guess the title from this description: Heaven and earth, parents of the Hecatonchires (Centimani), the Cyclopes, and the Titans.

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13. Guess the title from this description: Children of Uranus and Gaea, whom Zeus imprisoned in the bowels of the earth. Their names were Briareos (aka Aegaeon), Cottus, and Gyes.

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14. Guess the title from this description: Children of Uranus and Gaea, whom Zeus had to bury deep in the earth. Their names were Brontes (thunder), Steropes (lightning), and Arges (rapid flame). These beings predate those of Homer who were the sons of Poseidon (e.g., Polyphemus).

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15. Guess the title from this description: Titans. one of these Titans had 100 dragon heads and a serpent-covered body.

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16. Guess the title from this description: Children of Oceanus by his mother Gaea. these two produced: the Graeae (dino, Enyo, Pephrido), the Gorgons (Euryale, Stheno, Medusa), the Sirens (Leucosia, Ligeia, Parthenope), the Hesperides (Aegle, Arethusa, Erytheis), Scylla, Ladon, and Echidna.

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17. Guess the title from this description: Half-woman and half-snake; produced six monsters with her uncle, Typhon.

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18. Guess the title from this description: A tripartite monster with a goat's body, a lion's head, and a snake tail. The monster was killed by Bellerophon riding Pegasus. Pegasus sprang from a drop of blood that fell from the severed head of Medusa as it was being carried by Perseus. Later, Pegasus kicked the side of Mt. Helicon with his hoof and the Hippocrene Fountain sprang forth which is sacred to the Muses and the source of poetic inspiration.

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19. Guess the title from this description: The three-headed dog that guarded the entrance to the Underworld. He was tricked repeatedly with special doggy treats (some drugged) by heroes visiting the Underworld (i.e., dying and returning to life), and he was brought to the upper world by Hercules as his 12th labor.

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20. Guess the title from this description: Two-headed brother of Cerberus. He helped to guard Geryon's oxen and was killed by Hercules when he stole Geryon's cattle as his 10th labor. this creature mated with his mother Echidna (some say with his sister the Chimaera) to produce the Sphinx and the Nemean Lion.

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21. Guess the title from this description: A winged lion that had a woman's head and bronze claws. She lived on a rock outside Thebes and killed passers-by who could not solve the riddle of 'What walks on four legs in the morning, two at noon, and three at night?' Oedipus answered 'A man' (because a man crawls on all fours as a baby, walks on two legs as an adult, and uses a cane when older), and the creature jumped off her rock and committed suicide.

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22. Guess the title from this description: A lion with an impenetrable hide. Hercules had to strangle it as his first labor. He turned the lion inside out to clean it and wore it afterwards as his trademark.

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23. Guess the title from this description: A tripartite monster who is depicted as either a Siameses triplet with three bodies joined at the hips or with three upper torsos growing from one lower body. Since each of the monster's heads preferred special foods, Hercules was able to force the monster to kill itself by placing its special foods at opposite ends of a clearing after forcing the monster to work up an appetite by chasing him. Depending on its depiction, the monster either tore itself to pieces trying to get to its special foods or starved to death since each head was unwilling to let the other eat first.

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24. Guess the title from this description: A water serpent with nine heads. When Hercules tried to kill it (as his second labor) by cutting off its heads, two would grow back from each severed neck. Hercules finally accepted forbidden help from his charioteer, Iolaus, who burned each severed neck with a torch before the heads could grow again. The hydra's last head was immortal and had to be buried under a boulder by Hercules.

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25. Guess the title from this description: Carrion birds (i.e., they eat dead flesh). They are sacred to Mars/Ares, the god of war, because they help to clean the fields of battle after the fighting is finished. Since these birds are sacred, they were considered good omens by Romulus and Remus when they were competing to name their new city.

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